

Welcome to the Arike Palliative Home Care Bulletin!

Within these pages, we share the stories and highlights of our work, emphasizing the difference it makes in the community. Your continued support helps us move forward and reach more people in need. Thank you for being with us on this journey.

Life changed in a moment

Mr. X is a middle-aged shopkeeper who once lived a very active and stable life running his own shop in the neighbourhood. The shop did well, and the family lived comfortably. Everything changed suddenly when he developed a major stroke that left him bedridden. He spent a long period in the hospital and had to undergo multiple surgeries and treatments. The stroke caused severe paralysis, and recovery has been slow. After returning home, he became completely dependent on his wife for all daily activities. With the shop closed, the family lost their only source of income. They have no medical insurance, and the financial strain has been extremely heavy.

The couple has two children: a young son still in school, and a daughter who had only just started her first job, taking it earlier than planned because of the crisis. At home, his wife now spends her entire day caring for him, supporting him with movement, feeding, hygiene, medicines, and follow-up visits. The responsibility has been overwhelming. Arike stepped in with sponsored home-based care. Along with the clinical team, volunteers also began visiting regularly, offering emotional support, providing basic assistance, and helping the family feel less alone. Regular nursing visits, physiotherapy, medicines, and volunteer support have brought some stability to the household.

There are many families like Mr. X's—facing sudden illness, financial strain, and emotional hardship.

You can make a difference. We believe that care goes beyond medicine; it's about connection. We encourage you to contribute, visit, and spend time with our patients and team. By becoming a part of the Arike Family, you help bring dignity and comfort to those navigating chronic illness.

Volunteer Diaries

I am grateful for the opportunity to volunteer with Arike. Even though it was for a short time, the experience had a deep impact on me. Visiting bedridden patients in their homes helped me understand the real meaning of social work in palliative care. What touched me most was how care goes beyond medical support.



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24/7
Emergency
Home Care

Listening to patients, understanding their struggles, and supporting families emotionally showed me how important social work is in this field. The way the team approaches each person with dignity and compassion was truly inspiring. This experience has motivated me to continue my support to the palliative care movement. I feel thankful to have been part of this work, even in a small way.

– **Ms. Anavadhya Mohan**

ACTIVITIES

Koode - Zone D Review Meeting



On March 1, 2026, a Review Meeting was held at Palarivattom (Zone D). The discussion focused on evaluating recent community interventions and streamlining the coordination of palliative care services within the zone to ensure better patient outreach.

Volunteer Training (Day 3) at Arrowwings Academy



The third day of volunteer training was successfully conducted at Arrowwings Academy, Kaloor, on March 2, 2026.

Koode Meeting at Chakkingal Road Residents Association

A Koode sensitization and planning meeting took place at Chakkingal Road Residents Association, Palarivattom, on March 7, 2026. Attended by Dr. Athul Joseph Manuel, Dr. George Tukanan, Mr. Ajayraj, and Mr. Mukesh, the discussion centered on building a robust neighborhood network to support chronically ill residents.



Pensioners Association Meeting at Kakkanad



On March 9, 2026, the Arike team, represented by Sheeba Mathews, Kareem, and Mukesh, met with the Pensioners Association in Kakkanad. The session highlighted the importance of elderly care and how retired professionals can contribute their time and experience to palliative volunteering and Koode.

Snehamritham Stalls by Rajagiri Social Work Students



As part of the Snehamritham Campaign, Social Work Department students of Rajagiri College of Social Sciences organised two awareness and fundraising stalls for Arike Palliative Care. One stall was set up at the Thanima event held at IMA on March 22, 2026, and the other at SRM Road.

The initiative aimed to sensitise the public about the importance of palliative care while also mobilising funds to support Arike's services. Through these stalls, the students created meaningful community engagement and helped spread awareness about compassionate, community-based care.



Zone B Review Meeting



A review meeting for Zone B was conducted at Chalikkavattom on March 26, 2026.

UC College Volunteer Training (Day 3) at Aluva

The final phase of the volunteer training for UC College students was held at District Hospital Aluva on March 28, 2026. The programme focused on the practical integration of student volunteers into the hospital's palliative wing and community visits.

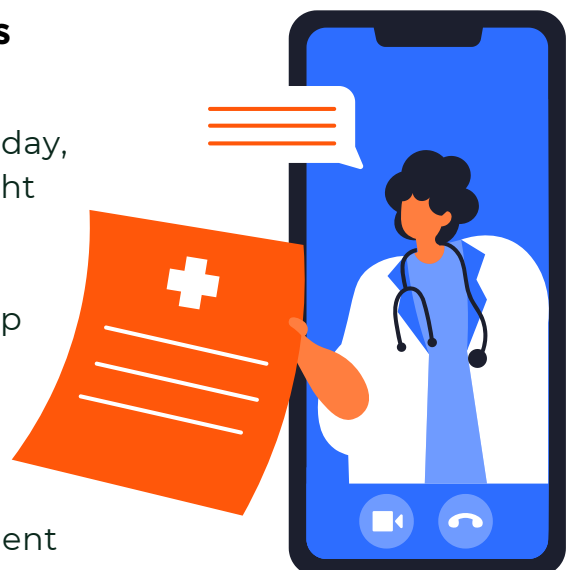
Training on Bereavement and Spirituality at District Hospital, Aluva

A specialized training session on Bereavement and Spirituality was conducted at District Hospital, Aluva on March 30, 2026. Facilitated by Donal Marshal, the session equipped participants with the sensitive communication skills needed to support families through grief and provide holistic care that addresses spiritual well-being.

Care Info

Managing Sleep Problems in Palliative Patients

- Maintain a regular sleep routine. Encourage the patient to sleep and wake at the same time each day, and avoid long daytime naps that can disturb night sleep.
- Create a calm and comfortable environment. Keep the room quiet, well-ventilated, and dimly lit, and make it dark at night to support natural sleep.
- Ensure basic needs are met before sleep. Give medicines, food, and water in advance so the patient is less likely to wake up due to discomfort.



A Heartfelt Thank You

At Arike, every act of kindness becomes a source of strength for the patients and families we serve. We extend our deepest gratitude to all our supporters whose generosity, trust, and encouragement continue to uplift our mission. Your contributions—big and small—help us deliver dignified, compassionate care to those facing serious health-related suffering.

Support Our Mission

We warmly encourage you to contribute to Arike, enabling us to make a meaningful and lasting difference in the lives of individuals requiring palliative care.

Payments can be transferred to our account.

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IFSC code : **FDRL0001380**

Branch : **Palarivattom**

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